Yale University Student Financial Services & Fellowship Programs

Official Guidelines: Yale College & Graduate School Need-Based Aid & Merit Fellowships

Section 1: Overview & Mission

Yale University commits to meeting **100% of demonstrated financial need** for all admitted undergraduate students, regardless of citizenship, immigration status, or national origin. The **Yale Fellowship & Scholarship Review Committee** oversees both need-based institutional grant distributions and prestigious competitive academic fellowships (including the Yale College Postgraduate Fellowships, Yale Summer Research Fellowships, and Graduate Dean's Merit Awards).

• **Administering Office**: Yale Student Financial Services (SFS) & Center for International and Professional Experience (CIPE).

• **Core Principle**: Need-blind admissions and full-need funding with a strict **No-Loan Policy** for undergraduate financial aid packages.

• **Academic Year Cost of Attendance (COA)**: Includes billed direct costs (Tuition, Housing, Food) and unbilled indirect costs (Books, Supplies, Personal Expenses, Travel).

• **Evaluation Mechanism**: Tripartite review combining deterministic compliance (pure code formulas), multi-agent academic evaluation (Academic Excellence, Leadership & Impact, Financial Need/Budget Feasibility), and final Committee Chair sign-off.

• **Application Deadline**: Annual priority deadline for institutional aid and fellowship consideration.

• **Required Submission Dossier**:

1. Student Academic & Financial Dossier (GPA, major, transcript summary, family income, assets).
2. Academic & Personal Statements (Research Proposal / Purpose Statement, Leadership & Community Impact).
3. Video Motivation Pitch (2-minute student video or audio statement).
4. Standardized Budget Breakdown (Parent Contribution, Student Share, Outside Resources).
5. 2 Academic / Professional Letters of Recommendation with verifiable citations.